

COOK INLET GAS



Alaska's gas machine, in cutaway.

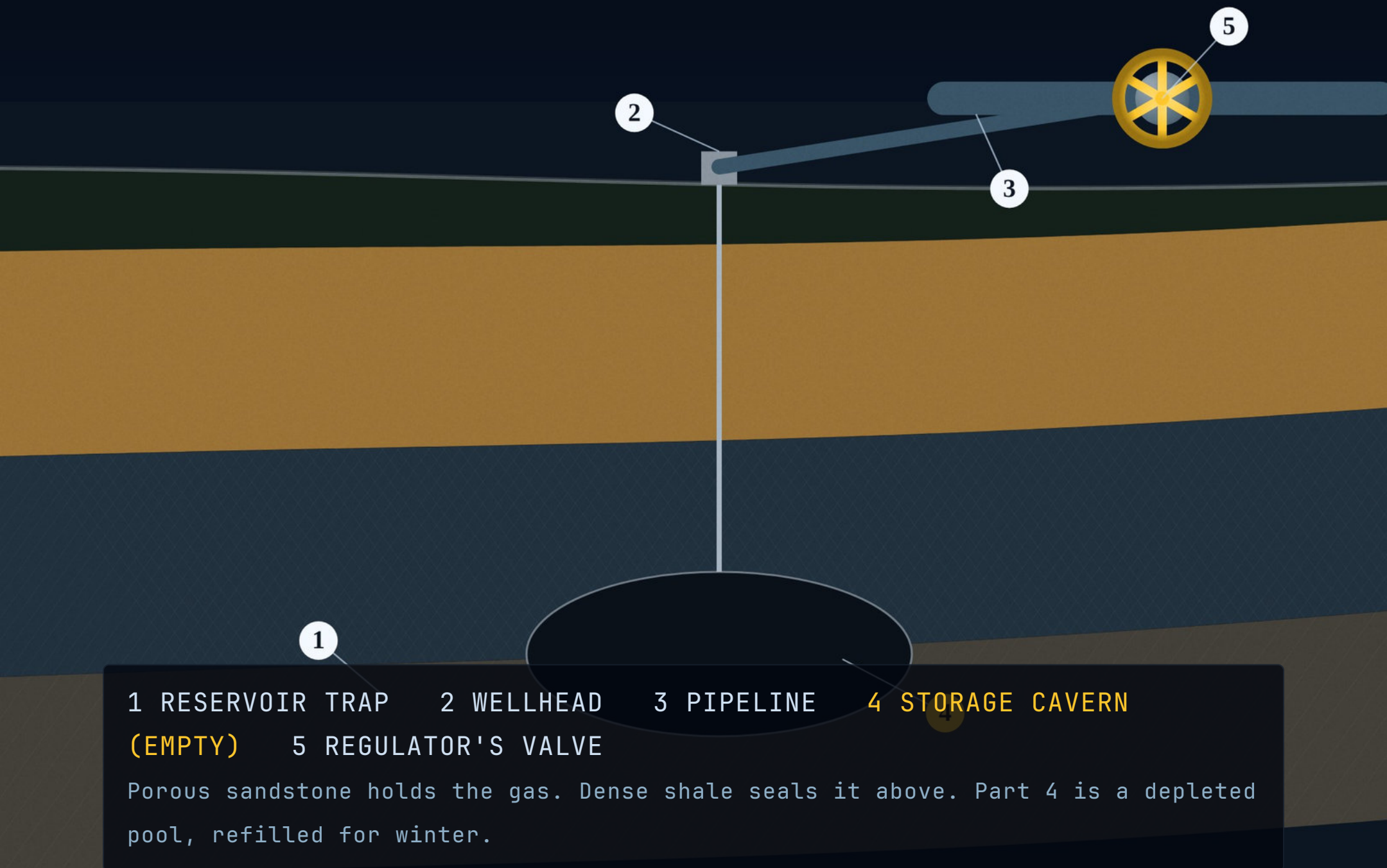
And the valve that just shut.



THE MACHINE

Five parts move gas from rock to furnace

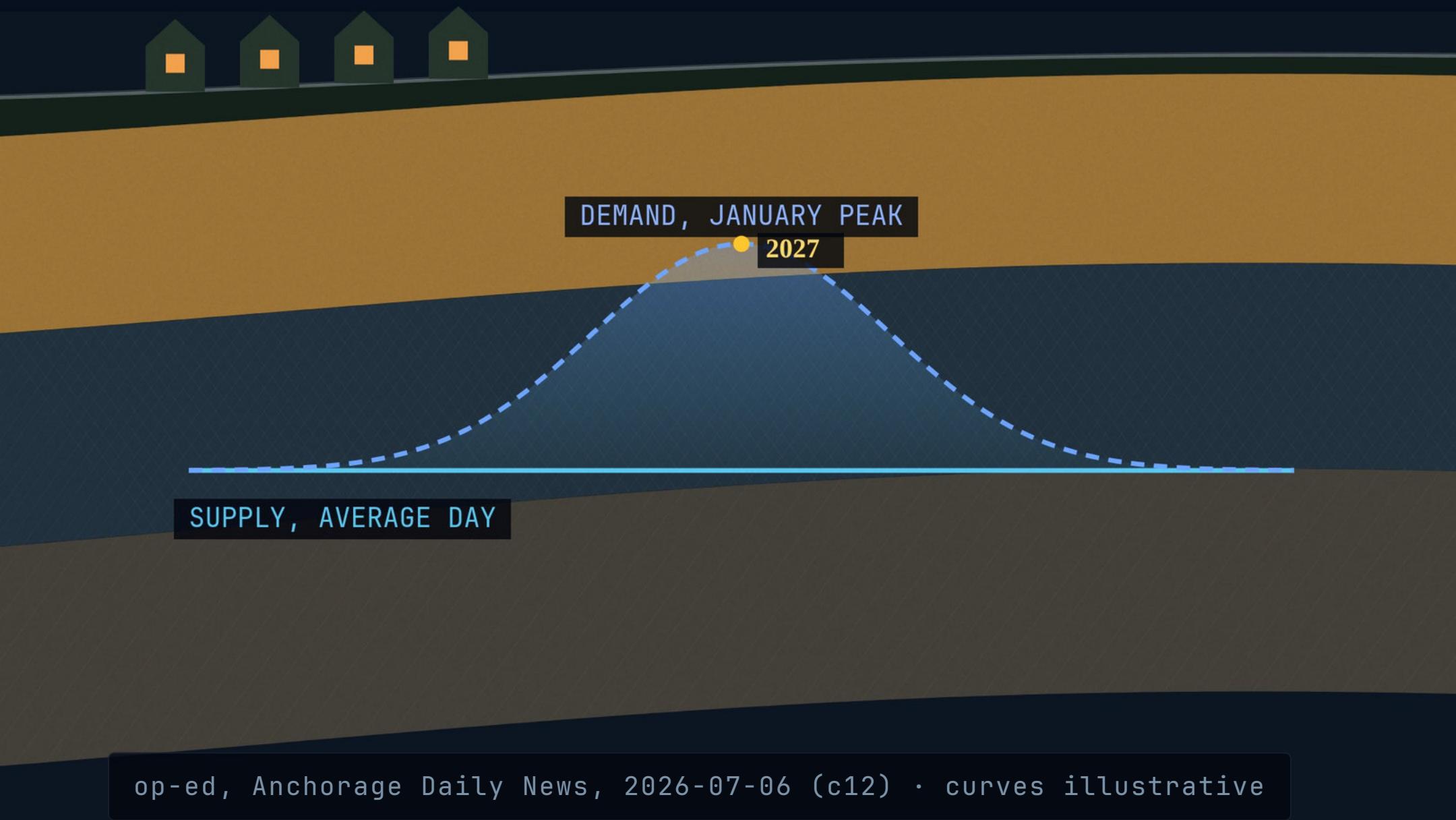
Reservoir trap, wellhead, pipeline, storage cavern, and the state regulator's valve. Part four is a battery for deep winter. Right now, it sits empty.



THE PROBLEM

Enough for an average day. Not for January.

Cook Inlet’s aging fields can meet a normal day, but not a deep-cold peak, and there is little storage to bridge the gap. A former state senator’s *op-ed* warns of a Southcentral shortfall by 2027.

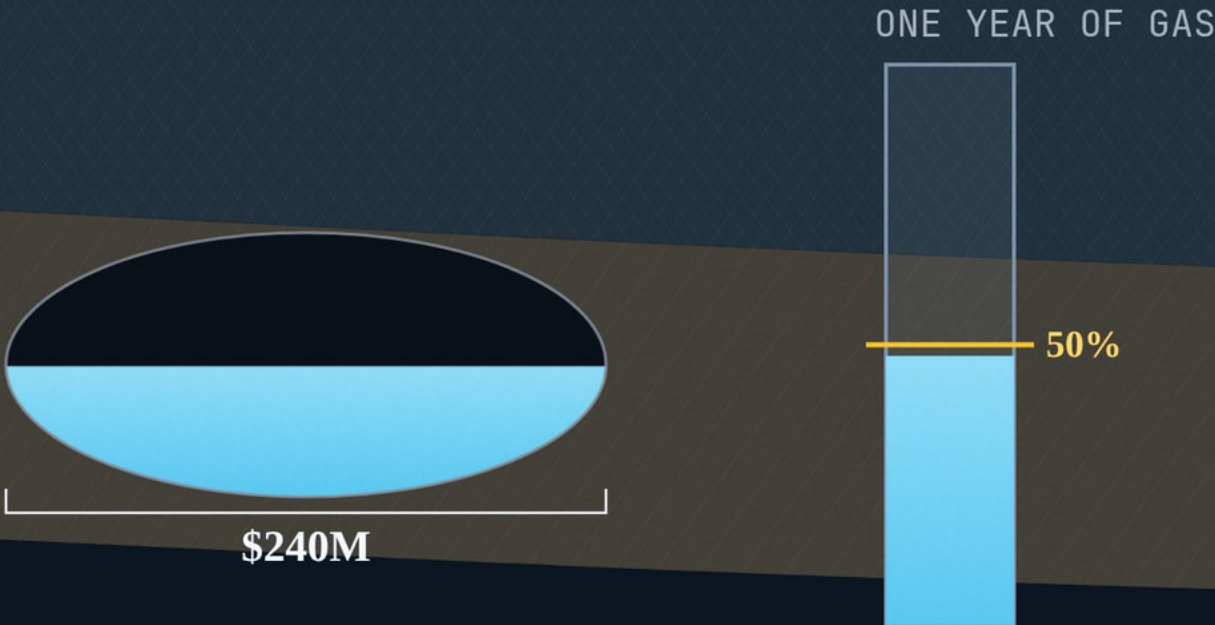


op-ed, Anchorage Daily News, 2026-07-06 (c12) · curves illustrative

Turn a dead reservoir into a winter battery

Enstar proposed buying the depleted Kenai Loop Pool from AIX Energy and refilling it to hold 25 billion cubic feet, close to half a year’s gas, for about \$240 million and up to \$12 a month on the average bill.

\$240M plan (c3) · 25 Bcf, near half annual demand (c6)
+\$12 / mo avg bill (c4)



THE GATE

Every fix runs through one valve

The Regulatory Commission of Alaska decides whether a utility's plan is prudent before customers ever pay for it.

RCA • PRUDENCE REVIEW

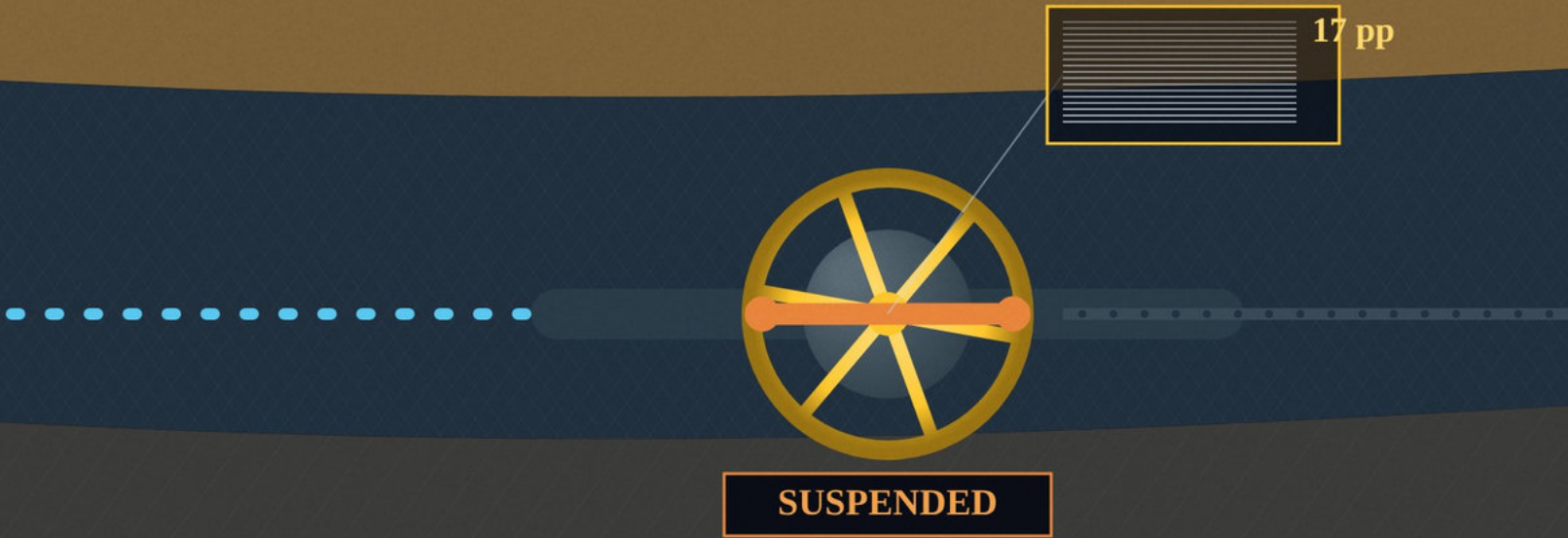


JULY 10

The regulator shut the valve

On July 10 the RCA denied the plan, calling it an *"extraordinary request"* that *"lacked basic information about the project."* The order ran 17 pages. Enstar's president said the company suspended the project.

RCA order · 17 pp (c2) · STATUS: SUSPENDED (c9)



THE HOLD TEST

Can it hold?

Three questions the fix could not answer. Any power promise should have to.

1 Hold the winter?

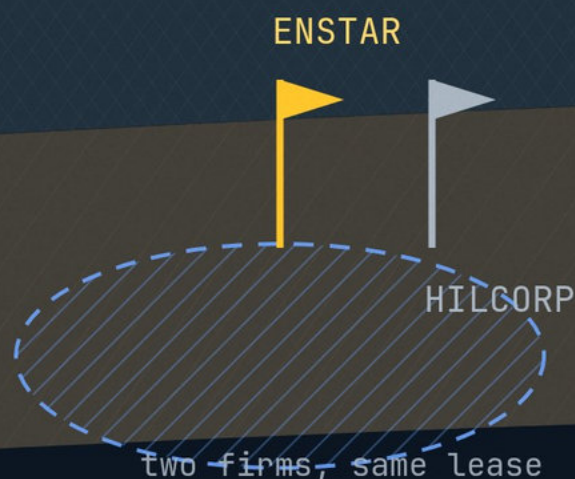
Even half a year of storage was denied. (c6, c1)

2 Hold the ground?

The state has not confirmed the pool can store gas, and two firms claim the same lease. (c7, c8)

3 Hold the bill?

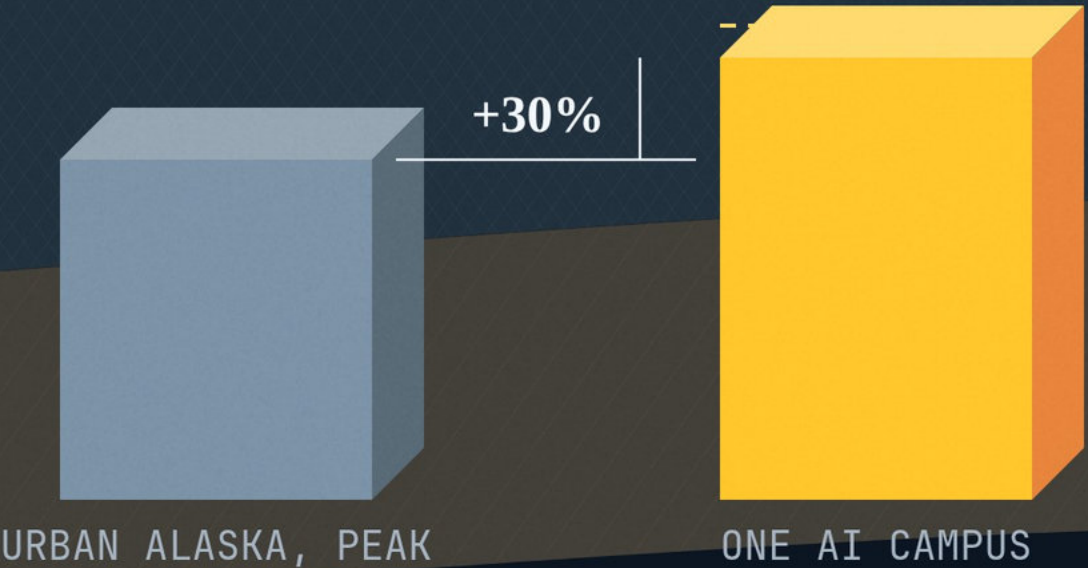
About \$12 a month, and the project is now suspended. (c4, c9)



Now measure what wants to plug in

One proposed North Slope AI campus, from STAK Energy, would generate *"a gigawatt or more, some 30% more than urban Alaska's peak demand."* More than \$10 billion at full buildout. Its comment window closes July 17.

STAK lease: 500+ comments, fewer than a dozen in favor (c15) · \$10B+ (c14) · window closes JUL 17 (c16)



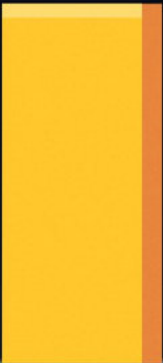
Northern Journal, Jul 3 (c13)

Gas storage and power demand are different units, not one sum.

ONE QUESTION

Store one winter first?

Should Alaska approve a gigawatt of AI load before it can store a single winter of gas?



ALASKA.AI

alaskaaihq.com

60°33'N · 151°15'W

Sources in comments.

09 / 09